READING PART 1

*Read the text. Fill in each gap with **ONE** word. You must use a word which is somewhere in the rest of the text*

LOS ANGELES FIRES

There are reports that landlords in Los Angeles are profiting from the wildfires that have destroyed many communities and thousands of homes. Many people lost their **1.** _____ in the fires. They now have nowhere to live. Tens of thousands of people are trying to find a house to rent. However, some **2.** _____ are suddenly raising their rents by thousands of dollars. Local newspapers are reporting that some rents in L.A. have doubled since the **3.** _____ began. Trying to make a profit in a crisis is called price gouging. California Governor Gavin Newsom said he would introduce price-gouging laws on January the 7th. This was after he declared a state of emergency. The wildfires have shocked America. More than 105,000 **4.** _____ had to leave their homes. The fires have destroyed large parts of some of the most exclusive areas of Los Angeles. Many celebrities have lost their beachfront properties. Model, singer and actress Paris Hilton lost her house in the upmarket area of Malibu. She wrote on social media: "It feels like my heart has shattered into a million pieces." Tina Knowles, the mother of Beyoncé, also **5.** _____ her house. She wrote on Instagram: "It was my favourite place, my sanctuary, my sacred happy **6.** _____. Now it is gone." Many people are blaming climate change for the fires. A lack of rain has left Los Angeles unusually dry. The risk of wildfires is high.

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 2

*Read the texts 7-14 and the statements A-J. Decide which text matches with the situation described in the statements. Each statement can be used **ONCE** only. There are **TWO** extra statements which you do not need to use. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.*

A. A program where students express their thoughts about real-world topics through debate.
B. A class focused on developing strength and encouraging a healthy lifestyle.
C. A course that gives learners a chance to explore traditional recipes from around the world.
D. A program that helps students improve their singing and musical performance.
E. A space where students use their imagination to create visual works of art.
F. A course where learners act on stage and practice performing in front of others.
G. A course that teaches the importance of protecting the planet through real action.
H. A class that helps students strengthen their writing in a creative and structured way.
I. A program that introduces the basics of using digital tools and technology.
J. A course for children who want to learn foreign languages through storytelling.

Teacher Jamshid

7. *Speak Your Mind.* This course is ideal for students interested in discussing world affairs and current events. Participants will engage in lively debates on social, environmental, and political issues while learning how to express opinions clearly and respectfully. By developing argumentation and speaking skills, students gain confidence and become more informed global citizens.

8. *Digital Futures.* In a world driven by innovation, this course introduces students to the exciting world of modern technology. From app development and basic coding to exploring AI and virtual reality, participants will learn how digital tools are changing our lives. The sessions also focus on digital responsibility and internet safety.

9. *Creative Art.* Perfect for imaginative learners, this course invites students to explore a wide range of artistic techniques. From mixed-media collages to digital design and sculpture, participants work on individual and group projects. The goal is to develop artistic skills, creativity, and personal expression through hands-on experience.

10. *On Stage!.* If your child loves to perform, this is the course for them. Students will take part in acting workshops, role plays, and stage rehearsals. They'll learn about body language, voice control, and how to work with others in a theatre environment. The course ends with a live performance open to parents and friends.

11. *Active Living.* This program promotes healthy habits through sports and movement-based activities. Participants will engage in games, stretching, team sports, and simple fitness routines. The aim is to build strength, coordination, and confidence while showing that exercise can be both fun and rewarding.

12. *Writers' Room.* For those passionate about storytelling, this course focuses on writing fiction, poetry, and short articles. Students will practice using descriptive language, creating characters, and building strong plots. They'll also receive feedback from peers and instructors to develop their writing voice and style.

13. *World Flavors.* Explore the rich traditions of global cuisine in this hands-on course. Students will learn how to prepare popular dishes from different countries, while discovering the cultural stories behind them. Lessons also include food safety, kitchen skills, and creative food presentation.

14. *EcoAction Club.* This course is perfect for environmentally conscious students. Participants will explore global environmental issues and take part in local eco-projects, such as clean-ups and recycling drives. The course encourages sustainable habits and teaches how small actions can lead to big change.

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 3

Read the text and choose the correct heading for each paragraph from the list of headings below. There are more headings than paragraphs, so you will not use all of them. You cannot use any heading more than once. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

A) Modern challenges in tea production **B)** The cultural and ceremonial evolution of tea **C)** Traditional medical uses of tea **D)** Environmental and ethical issues in the tea industry	**E)** Tea as a symbol of social connection and hospitality **F)** Historical and modern importance of tea in the global economy **G)** Scientific research into tea's health effects **H)** The future growth and trends in the tea industry

15. Tea culture has evolved over thousands of years, and its influence can be seen in various aspects of society, from art and literature to medicine and politics. In ancient China, tea was valued for its medicinal properties and was used to treat a variety of ailments, including digestive disorders and headaches. In Japan, tea ceremonies became an essential part of the country's cultural identity, emphasizing harmony, respect, and tranquility. Today, tea continues to be a significant cultural symbol in many countries, and its consumption has been linked to numerous health benefits, such as reducing the risk of cardiovascular disease and certain types of cancer.

16. In many cultures, tea is more than just a beverage; it is a symbol of hospitality and social interaction. In Japan, the tea ceremony, or cha-no-yu, is a highly ritualized social event that involves the preparation and serving of matcha, a powdered green tea. The ceremony emphasizes harmony, respect, and tranquility, and is seen as a way to promote social and spiritual harmony. Similarly, in Morocco, the serving of mint tea, or "atai," is an important part of hospitality. It is customary for the host to prepare and serve the tea to guests as a sign of welcome and respect. The custom of serving tea as a symbol of hospitality in Uzbekistan, where the ritual of making and serving tea takes on a significant cultural meaning, involves a complex process of preparing, brewing, and presenting the tea, which is steeped in centuries of tradition and social etiquette.

17. Tea has also played a significant role in the global economy. The tea trade played a crucial role in the expansion of European empires, as European countries sought to establish trade routes with tea-producing countries such as China and India. The British East India Company, for example, monopolized the tea trade with China in the 18th century, leading to the Opium Wars and the eventual colonization of Hong Kong. Today, tea remains an important export commodity for many countries, with China and India being the largest tea producers in the world.

18. In addition to its economic and social significance, tea has also been the subject of scientific research. Studies have shown that tea consumption is associated with a variety of health benefits, including reduced risk

Teacher Jamshid

of cardiovascular disease, cancer, and neurodegenerative disorders. The polyphenols and antioxidants found in tea have been shown to have anti-inflammatory and neuroprotective effects, and may also help to improve cognitive function.

19. Despite its widespread popularity, tea production and consumption are not without challenges. Climate change, for example, is affecting tea production in many regions, with rising temperatures and changing precipitation patterns leading to reduced yields and lower quality tea. Additionally, the tea industry faces issues of labor exploitation, particularly in tea-producing countries such as India and Sri Lanka, where workers are often paid very low wages and work in poor conditions.

20. While tea has been consumed for thousands of years, its popularity continues to grow. The global tea market is expected to reach a value of $73.6 billion by 2027, with Asia being the largest consumer and producer of tea. In addition, the demand for specialty teas, such as herbal and green teas, is increasing, with a projected growth rate of 6.8% from 2020 to 2027. However, the tea industry also faces challenges such as climate change, which can impact tea production and quality.

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 4

Read the following text for questions 21-29.

WORKING REMOTELY

As technology advances and people's lifestyles change, more and more companies are offering their employees the option to work remotely. In fact, research shows that 70% of the global workforce works from home at least one day per week. While this concept is gaining in popularity, not everyone understands its benefits. In this article, we will discuss the advantages of working remotely and why it is a great option for both employers and employees.

First and foremost, working remotely allows employees to have a better work-life balance. They have the flexibility to schedule their work around their personal obligations, such as taking care of children or attending appointments. This can lead to increased job satisfaction and lower levels of stress. In addition, remote work can save employees time and money, as they do not have to commute to an office, spend money on transportation, or buy expensive office attire.

In addition, remote work can benefit employers as well. It allows them to recruit the most talented employees from all over the world, rather than limiting their search to a specific geographic area. This can lead to a more diverse and skilled workforce. Additionally, remote work can save employers money on office space, utilities, and other overhead costs. Finally, by offering remote work options, employers can show their employees that they trust and respect them, which can lead to increased loyalty and productivity.

One of the biggest myths about remote work is that it leads to decreased productivity. However, research shows that remote workers are actually more productive than their office-bound counterparts. They have fewer distractions, fewer meetings, and more autonomy over their work. In addition, remote work can lead to increased creativity, as employees have more freedom to work in environments that inspire them.

Of course, working remotely is not without its challenges. One of the biggest hurdles is overcoming the absence of face-to-face communication. Remote workers must be comfortable with using technology to communicate with their colleagues, such as chat, email, video conferencing, and project management software. Additionally, remote workers must be able to manage their time effectively and remain disciplined, as distractions can easily arise.

In conclusion, working remotely is a flexible and beneficial option for both employers and employees. By providing employees with greater flexibility, employers can attract and retain a more diverse and talented workforce. Moreover, remote work can lead to increased productivity, creativity, and job satisfaction. As technology and lifestyles continue to change, remote work is likely to become even more popular and mainstream, so it is important for both employers and employees to be prepared to adopt this new way of working.

Teacher Jamshid

For questions 21-24, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

21. What is one benefit of remote work for employees?

A) Earn higher salaries

B) Work fewer hours

C) Design their schedules

D) Avoid using technology

22. How can businesses benefit from remote work?

A) Reduce operational costs

B) Increase rent payments

C) Hire more people

D) Improve customer service

23. What is one challenge of remote work?

A) Too many meetings

B) Difficult to communicate

C) Lack of equipment

D) More traffic

24. What is one impact of remote work on major cities?

A) Increase housing costs

B) Reduce traffic and air pollution

C) Create new jobs

D) Improve entertainment venues

For questions 25-29, decide if the following statements agree with the information given in the text. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

25. Remote work has become a common way of working

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

26. Some industries cannot eliminate physical offices

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

27. In the future, all offices work will shift online work

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

28. Online workers are more productive

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

29. Digital communication tools help improve online works

A) True **B)** False **C)** No information

Teacher Jamshid

READING PART 5

Read the following text for questions 30-35.

BAD DREAMS AND DEMENTIA

People who experience frequent bad dreams in middle age may experience a faster rate of cognitive decline and be at higher risk of dementia (a medical condition that affects especially old people, causing the memory and other mental abilities to gradually become worse, and leading to confused behaviour) as they get older. If confirmed, the research could eventually lead to new ways of screening for dementia and interventions to slow the rate of decline.

Most people experience bad dreams from time to time, but approximately 5% of adults experience nightmares — dreams distressing enough to wake them up — at least once a week. Stress, anxiety, and sleep loss are all potential triggers. Still, previous research on people with Parkinson's disease has also linked frequent distressing dreams to faster rates of cognitive decline, and an increased risk of developing dementia in the future.

To investigate whether the same might be true of healthy adults, scientists at the University of Birmingham turned to data from three previous studies that have examined people's sleep quality and then followed them over many years, assessing their brain health as well as other outcomes. This included more than 600 middle-aged adults (aged 35 to 64), and 2,600 people aged 79 and older. Their data were analysed using statistical software to find out whether those who experienced a higher frequency of distressing dreams were more likely to go on to experience cognitive decline and be diagnosed with dementia.

The research, published in clinical medicine, found that middle-aged people who experienced bad dreams at least once a week were four times more likely to experience cognitive decline over the following decade than those who rarely had nightmares. Among elderly participants, those who frequently reported distressing dreams were twice as likely to be diagnosed with dementia in subsequent years. One possibility is that people with frequent bad dreams have poor quality sleep, which could gradually lead to increased proteins associated with dementia. Another is the existence of some genetic factor that claims both phenomena.

However, scientists' working hypothesis is that the loss of function of cells within the brain's right frontal part makes it harder for people to control their emotions while dreaming, leading to nightmares. Problematic conditions such as Parkinson's disease and Alzheimer's disease often start many years before somebody is diagnosed. In some individuals who already have an underlying disease, bad dreams and nightmares might be one of the earliest signs. Only some adults who regularly have bad dreams are likely to develop dementia, however, assuming this link is confirmed, bad dreams could eventually be used to identify individuals at high risk.

Teacher Jamshid

"The best way to deal with dementia is to prevent it from occurring, and there are several risk factors — poor diet, lack of exercise, smoking, and drinking too much alcohol. If we can identify who's at high risk for getting dementia several years or even decades earlier, we may be able to slow down the start, or maybe even prevent it altogether." Curiously, the study found that the associations were stronger for men than for women. For example, older men experiencing nightmares on a weekly basis were five times more likely to develop dementia than older men reporting no bad dreams – but in women, the increase in risk was only 41%.

Related to this, previous research has suggested that nightmares are more common among women during youth and middle-age, but that men's risk of nightmares increases in later life. One possibility is that dementia-linked nightmares are only those that develop during older age, and which men are more predisposed to, Otaiku said.

*For questions 30-33, fill in the missing information in the numbered spaces. Write no more than **ONE WORD** and / or **A NUMBER** for each question.*

30. Nightmares that are severe enough to disrupt sleep are reported weekly by around _____ of the adult population.

31. The number of elderly individuals whose long-term data was examined in the study exceeded _____.

32. Weekly bad dreams increased the likelihood of cognitive decline in middle-aged individuals by a factor of _____.

33. Reduced activity in a section of the brain responsible for emotional regulation — specifically the _____ frontal region — may contribute to nightmare occurrence.

For questions 34-35, choose the correct answer A, B, C, or D. Mark your answers on the answer sheet.

34. What does the University of Birmingham's research mainly suggest?

A) Nightmares have a stronger connection to Parkinson's than to Alzheimer's.

B) Sleep quality has little impact on long-term brain function.

C) Persistent, distressing dreams might be an early indicator of future neurological decline.

D) People with dementia remember their dreams more vividly.

35. What gender-related trend was observed in the findings?

A) Nightmare frequency remains constant across all ages in women.

B) Men in later life showed a sharper rise in dementia risk linked to nightmares.

C) The nightmare-dementia relationship was equally significant in both genders.

D) Women are more genetically predisposed to dementia symptoms than men.

Teacher Jamshid